

Analyzing evidence for argumentative essay on gaming data

07/20/2026 15:07:43

Act as a tutor. I am preparing to write an argumentative essay based on...

Nice, focused outline — you've clearly done the reading. Here's a tutor's...

Ok, before I start writing, can you turn this feedback into a planning list f...

Here's a paragraph-by-paragraph planning list based on your outline. Us...

Ok here is my revised introduction "For a game built around it's...

Good progress — here's what stands out as missing, unclear, or repetitiv...



Act as a tutor. I am preparing to write an argumentative essay based on my attached outline. Do not write or change any sentences or paragraphs for me. Can you point out which points in my body sections might overlap and tell me whether each piece of evidence supports the claims, and give me some questions to think about while writing. Some more specific questions, what should I consider when I am using the Riot Games Patch 12.22 notes and the OP.GG image as evidence than analyzing them. What do I need to explain when connecting this evidence to the vectoralist class and also the big data divide? Also, can you help me think through how the Destiny 2/Bungie example could work as a counterargument and what I should focus on when writing about it.

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Identified structural overlaps and scrutinized evidence-claim alignment throughout. ▾

- 🕒 I should focus on providing tutoring feedback rather than writing their content for them. Let me organize my response around key areas: identifying overlap points in their argument, checking how well their evidence supports their claims, asking clarifying questions about the Patch 12.22/OP.GG image they mentioned, exploring connections between the vectoralist and big data divide concepts, and helping them develop a stronger counterargument about Destiny 2.

I'm noticing their sections have some structural overlap—particularly how Patch 12.22 functions as evidence. It seems to support both their point about Riot controlling information access (vectoralist class) and their point about unequal player-developer relationships (API control), so I should ask which argument it's meant to strengthen. Their Section A sets up a concession about metagaming as competitive advantage, while Sections B and C both emphasize Riot's power, which creates some repetition I should help them address.

I'm also flagging that the Wark quote appears twice in different subsections—worth checking if both citations are necessary. For their evidence, the OP.GG image needs accompanying analysis to explain what it demonstrates about data becoming competitive advantage, and the Donaldson quote directly supports their metagame expertise point well. The Wark definition of vectoralist class is useful as a theoretical lens, but they need to explicitly connect how Riot fits that definition—specifically whether Riot operates as described in the quote about labor, capital, and information control.

The Patch 12.22 evidence is doing double duty across two arguments, so I should clarify what mechanism it illustrates and whether Riot imposed this change unilaterally. For the OP.GG image, I need to specify what data was visible before the patch, what advantage it provided, and acknowledge that the image is now historical evidence of what changed. ...

☑ Done

Nice, focused outline — you've clearly done the reading. Here's a tutor's pass on structure, evidence, and things to wrestle with as you draft. I'm not writing any of the essay for you; this is just questions and diagnostic notes.

Where your sections overlap

B.c (Patch 12.22) and C.a look like they're proving the same thing. B.c says Riot restricted lobby data because it opposed metagaming/dodging. C.a says players have limited control over how their data is collected/used, and cites the API existing as proof. Both are really making the point "Riot decides what happens to player data" — just with different evidence. Ask yourself: is Patch 12.22 there to show Riot *exercising* vectoralist power (a concrete act), while C is there to show the *structural* reason that power exists (Riot owns the pipes, so it can always do this)? If so, say that explicitly — otherwise a reader will feel B and C are repeating each other rather than building an argument.

The Wark quote appears twice (B.i as the definition, B.c citing Wark again for the patch). Once you've defined the term in B.i, you don't need to re-cite Wark in B.c — you'd just be applying the definition you already gave. Re-citing there might actually weaken it, since it looks like the definition itself is doing double duty as analysis.

Section A and Sections B/C are doing different jobs — make sure that's intentional. A shows players *do* get a real competitive edge from data (this is almost a concession to the counterargument). B and C then argue that despite that edge, Riot holds the actual power. That's a solid structure, but it means A needs to feel like it's setting up something B/C will complicate — not just be a separate mini-argument about metagaming for its own sake.

Evidence-to-claim fit

- **Donaldson (A.b.i)** — supports directly. It's making a claim about metagame expertise mattering for competitive success, which is exactly what A.b argues.
- **Bennett (C.a.ii)** — this quote just *describes* that the API exists and what data it contains. It doesn't itself claim players lack control. You'll need a bridging

sentence explaining *why* the existence of this API structure means players don't control their own data — the quote alone doesn't make that leap for you.

- **Ouellette & Gray (C.b.i)** — supports directly, it's their own definition of the concept you're naming.
- **Wark (B.i)** — supports the definition, but you'll need to explicitly map Riot onto it (see below) since the quote is about vectoralists in general, not gaming specifically.

Questions for Patch 12.22 and the OP.GG image

- What *exactly* changed in the patch — is it anonymizing names, hiding stats, or both? Precision here matters for your analysis.
- What reason did Riot give publicly for the change, versus what power/incentive might actually be behind it? Is there a gap between stated and actual motive worth pointing out?
- Whose decision was this — did players or OP.GG have any input, or was it unilaterally imposed? That unilateral aspect is probably your strongest link to "vectoralist," so make sure you name it directly rather than assuming the reader infers it.
- For the image: what specific pieces of data is it showing (win rate, KDA, recent streaks), and which of those specifically enable the "judge a teammate and dodge" behavior you describe in A.a.i? Don't just show the image — walk through 2-3 concrete data points in it that a player would actually use.
- Since the image is *pre*-patch, are you using it to show what power players used to have, so the patch reads as Riot clawing it back? Making that contrast explicit will do a lot of work for your thesis.

Connecting evidence to the theory

Vectoralist class: Wark's definition is about power over "labor and capital" shifting to power over "information." You need one clear sentence (in your own words when drafting) mapping the abstract terms onto League specifically: what plays the role of "land," what plays the role of "labor," and how the API/servers are the "information" Riot controls instead. Right now the outline states the definition and then jumps straight to the patch — the connective tissue between them is the part you still need to think through.

Big data divide: Ouellette & Gray's point is about individuals having no say in the *terms* under which their data is used. Ask yourself: is your evidence just showing that Riot *collects* data, or is it showing that players have *no say* in that collection? Those are different claims — collection alone doesn't prove divide, lack of consent/control does. Make sure the evidence you pick actually demonstrates the second, not just the first.

Thinking through the Destiny 2 counterargument

A few things to nail down before you write it:

- What's Bungie's actual policy on third-party API use? Your rebuttal (V.b) claims Bungie could shut it down anytime — do you have a source confirming that, or is it an assumption? If you don't have evidence either way, that's worth checking, since your rebuttal depends on it.
- Is DIM actually officially sanctioned, or just tolerated? That distinction affects how strong the counterargument is — "officially supported" is a much bigger challenge to your thesis than "unofficially tolerated."
- Your rebuttal is essentially "power is still conditional even if generous." Make sure you're not just restating that Bungie *could* revoke access — is there any evidence they've actually threatened or done so, similar to how you have concrete Patch 12.22 evidence for Riot? A counterargument section is more convincing if the rebuttal has the same kind of specific, sourced evidence as your main argument, rather than a hypothetical.
- Consider: does using Destiny 2 actually get you a *stronger* counterargument than a hypothetical? If Bungie has never restricted access the way Riot did, that's actually the best version of the counterargument to grapple with honestly — rather than picking an example that's easy to dismiss.

If you want, once you have a draft, I'm happy to look at how the paragraphs actually execute this reasoning.

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Ok, before I start writing, can you turn this feedback into a planning list for each paragraph. For each talk about maybe what I need to prove and if I have enough evidence or like what information I still need to go over. Keep it as notes and things I need to expand on.

7/20/2026, 2:12:10 PM



Deliberated presentation format for structured essay planning notes. ▾

🕒 I'm weighing whether to present this as a markdown artifact or inline reference content—it's structured planning notes organized by essay section that the user will reference while writing, which suggests artifact format, though the guidelines note that lists and structured content don't strictly require artifacts.

✓ Done

Here's a paragraph-by-paragraph planning list based on your outline. Use this as scratch notes before drafting — fill in the blanks as you go.

Section A (Background)

Need to prove: That OP.GG-style data access lets players make real competitive decisions (dodging, judging teammates) before the patch existed.

Evidence status: You have the OP.GG image and general knowledge of the practice — enough to describe the phenomenon.

Still need to think through:

- Specific data points from the image you'll actually name (win rate, KDA, loss streak) rather than describing it generally
- Whether this paragraph is purely descriptive/background, or if you want it to already hint at the "but Riot can take this away" tension that comes later

III.A (Third-party apps = competitive edge)

Need to prove: Mechanical skill alone doesn't guarantee ranked success; metagame data access matters too.

Evidence status: Donaldson quote fits well and directly supports this.

Still need to expand on:

- A sentence connecting Donaldson's general claim about "metagame expertise" to the *specific* mechanism of OP.GG data (Donaldson isn't about OP.GG specifically — you're applying it)
- Decide if the dodge/counterpick/pressure examples need one concrete illustration each, or if one is enough

III.B (Vectoralist class)

Need to prove: Riot fits Wark's definition of vectoralist — power through controlling information, not land/industry.

Evidence status: Wark quote is solid for the definition; Patch 12.22 is solid as the "act of power" example.

Still need to think through:

- The mapping step: what in League plays the role of "land," what plays "labor," what plays "information" — this connective sentence doesn't exist yet in your outline
- Whether citing Wark a second time next to the patch is necessary, or if it's redundant now that B.i already defined the term
- Look up/confirm: what did Riot's own patch notes say was the *reason* for the change? Compare that stated reason to the "vectoralist power" reading — is there a gap worth naming?

III.C (API creates unequal relationship / big data divide)

Need to prove: Players and third-party developers both have no say over how their data is collected/used — not just that data collection exists.

Evidence status: Bennett quote proves the API *exists* and what it contains. Ouellette & Gray quote proves the *definition* of big data divide. Neither quote, on its own, proves players lack control — that link is still yours to make.

Still need to expand on:

- The bridge sentence: why does the existence of this API structure specifically mean players have no influence over the terms of their own data? (This is the biggest gap right now.)
- Whether you want a distinct example of "no say" — e.g., can players opt out of appearing in others' match history data? If you know a concrete detail like that,

it'd strengthen this more than describing the API's contents.

- How C is different from B.c (Patch 12.22) so they don't feel like restating each other — maybe B.c = an act of power, C = the structural reason that act was possible.

IV (Counterargument — Destiny 2/DIM)

Need to prove: That someone could reasonably think open API access shifts power to the community — and that your rebuttal (power is still conditional) actually holds up.

Evidence status: Weakest evidence in the outline right now — you have DIM's existence, but no source on Bungie's actual policy or history of restricting/threatening access.

Still need to go over:

- Confirm whether Bungie has ever changed, restricted, or threatened API access for DIM — if yes, that's your strongest rebuttal evidence, directly parallel to Patch 12.22. If no, be honest that your rebuttal is hypothetical, and consider softening the claim accordingly.
- Whether DIM is officially sanctioned/partnered or just unofficially tolerated — changes how strong the counterexample is against you
- Consider whether a stronger version of the counterargument is worth engaging: "Bungie has never had to restrict this, so maybe player power *can* be durable" — grappling with the strongest form of the objection, not just the easiest one to knock down

V (Conclusion)

Need to prove: That the League example generalizes to a broader point about data availability $\neq$ data control, plus your call for developer transparency.

Evidence status: No new evidence needed here — this is synthesis.

Still need to think through:

- Make sure the conclusion's claim (developers should be more transparent) actually follows from what you argued, rather than introducing a new idea not supported earlier — is transparency the fix for the vectoralist problem, or a separate ask?

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Ok here is my revised introduction "For a game built around its competitiveness, League of Legends gives its players surprisingly little control over the information that can affect how they compete. Metagaming is defined as "the relationship between the game and outside elements, including everything from player attitudes and play styles to social reputations and social contexts in which the game is played" (Salen, 2003) (cited in Donaldson, 2017). In ranked League of Legends, a team based 5 versus 5 multiplayer online battle arena (MOBA), third-party applications such as OP.GG previously allowed players to connect summoner usernames with performance statistics like win rates, KDA (kills, deaths, and assists), champion mastery/experience, and recent win or loss streaks during the pre-game champion selection. This information allowed players to judge their teammates before a match, pressure them to change champions, or dodge the lobby entirely. In Patch 12.22, Riot replaced most allied summoner names with anonymous names during ranked champion selection because they are opposed to players using lobby information to metagame and pressure others to dodge (Riot Riru, 2022). Although players create this data through their matches and third-party developers turn it into useful tools, Riot controls the servers and application programming interface (API) where the information is made publicly available. Even though third-party applications allow League of Legends players to use data for a competitive advantage, Riot Games still holds the greater power because its control over the API creates the type of unequal information relationship described in Wark's vectoralist class and Ouellette's big data divide (Wark, 2015) (Ouellette, 2017). By analyzing Patch 12.22, Riot's API policies, and community sentiment to these changes, this essay will examine the unequal relationship between Riot Games, players, and third-party developers while also considering counterarguments about how API access can

give gaming communities more power and potentially improve everyone's experience."

Does it give enough context for the final essay, explain the main issue, have a clear thesis, and go over all of the main points. Please only point out important things that are missing or unclear or repetitive. Do not rewrite it or suggest anything new.

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Identified inconsistencies, grammar errors, and repetitive phrasing throughout introduction. ▾

🕒 I'm evaluating the introduction against key criteria—checking whether it establishes context for MOBA and metagaming, explains OP.GG and the patch, states the main issue clearly, and previews all the major sections. The definitions and context seem solid, but I need to identify what's missing or unclear in how it sets up the argument.

I notice "community sentiment" appears in the intro but wasn't in the outline, which is inconsistent. The counterargument section mentions API access and gaming communities but doesn't name Destiny 2 specifically—that's a minor generality issue. There's also repetitive phrasing around how players use lobby information to pressure teammates into dodging, which gets echoed again when discussing Riot's opposition. I'm catching some grammar issues too: "it's competitiveness" should be "its competitiveness," and the pronoun agreement with "they are opposed" when referring to Riot as a singular entity needs fixing.

🕒 Done

Good progress — here's what stands out as missing, unclear, or repetitive, without any rewriting:

Missing / not matching your outline:

- You mention "community sentiment to these changes" as something the essay will analyze, but this wasn't in your outline anywhere (not in III, IV, or V). Is this new evidence you're planning to add, or did you mean something else (like player reactions to Patch 12.22 specifically)? If it's new, you'll need to figure out where it fits in your body paragraphs and what source supports it.
- The counterargument is described only generally ("gaming communities more power") — Destiny 2/DIM isn't named. Depending on how specific you want your intro to be, a reader won't know yet what counterexample you're using.

- No hint of your conclusion's call for developer transparency — intros don't always need this, but since it's your paper's actual ask, consider whether leaving it out changes what the essay is "for."

Unclear:

- "Riot controls the servers and application programming interface (API) where the information is made publicly available" — this sentence is doing a lot of work but doesn't yet connect to *why* that control constitutes an "unequal relationship" (the thesis leans on this idea, so the connective logic here matters).
- Citation says "Ouellette's big data divide" but your reference list has it as Ouellette & Gray — dropping Gray here could be a citation accuracy issue.
- "because they are opposed to players using lobby information" — pronoun "they" refers to Riot (a company/singular entity), which reads a bit inconsistently, and this is in present tense while the rest of that sentence narrates a past event (2022 patch).

Repetitive:

- The idea of players using lobby data to "pressure others to dodge" appears twice in close proximity — once describing what players do with OP.GG data, and again describing Riot's stated reason for the patch. Since it's the same phrase/concept restated, consider whether both instances are necessary or if one is doing the job.

Everything else — the metagaming definition, MOBA context, OP.GG explanation, and the thesis linking vectoralist class + big data divide — covers the required elements clearly.

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